

The Justice and Home Affairs Council (JHA) is one of the configurations of the Council of the European Union and is composed of the justice and home affairs ministers of the 27 European Union member states.

Composition

JHA is composed of the justice and home affairs ministers of the 27 European Union member states. While most member states send one minister for both sectors, others send one minister for justice and another for home affairs.

The European Commissioner for Home Affairs, the European Commissioner for Justice and the European Commissioner for Equality also participate in the meetings.

Tasks

The Justice and Home Affairs Council develops cooperation and common policies on various cross-border issues, with the aim of building an EU-wide area of justice.

Cross-border issues include guaranteeing fundamental rights, free movement of citizens, civil protection, asylum and immigration matters, common investigations into cross-border organised crime, the EU's security strategy, including the fight against terrorism and organised crime, cybercrime and violent radicalisation.

The council covers legislation relating to:

Free movement of persons, asylum and immigration

Judicial cooperation in civil matters

Judicial cooperation in criminal matters

Police and customs cooperation

European Union citizenship

Combating discrimination

Fight against terrorism

Fight against organized crime

Fight against trafficking in human beings

Combating drugs

Justice, freedom and security: Enlargement

Legislative procedure

Since the entry into force of the Lisbon Treaty, the Council takes its decisions on most justice and home affairs legislation in co-decision with the European Parliament according to the ordinary legislative procedure.

See also

Area of freedom, security and justice

European Parliament Committee on Civil Liberties, Justice and Home Affairs

European Commission

European Commissioner for Justice

European Commissioner for Equality

European Commissioner for Home Affairs

References

External links

About the Justice and Home Affairs Council

Press releases of the Justice and Home Affairs Council